



The Garamut “The message sender”

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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APPRECIATING WHAT WE HAVE

A proverb – statement – adage - truism

In my time of reflection this morning this statement “*I complained about my sore feet until I met a man with no legs*” was impressed on me.

- This is echoed in the Persian proverb. “*I was grumbling as I walked with no shoes, until I met a man with no feet.*”
- And William Shakespeare the great English playwright, poet, actor wrote a similar thing - “*I cried when I had no shoes, but I stopped crying when I saw a man without legs. Life is full blessings, sometimes we don’t value it.*”

The message - BEING THANKFUL FOR WHAT WE DO HAVE

- * I was challenged again with this truth and felt I needed to take a closer look at my own life and practice.
- * Maybe there is a message for you in this proverb and Biblical truth.

How blessed we are.

- * As believers in Christ, we all need to be reminded how blessed and well off we are compared with many others that are in close or far proximity to where we live out our daily lives.
- * If any of us are questioning the fact of how fortunate and blessed we are – then we should go and visit these three places - The slums, The hospitals, and The cemetery – Maybe there you will see people in more serious situations than yours.

Proverb. *A wise man does not grieve for the things which he has not but rejoices for the things which he has.*

Grumblers & complainers

- * There have always been ungrateful never satisfied people who grumble and complain about what they lack or don’t have and fail to appreciate what they do have.

But God’s word says: *Do all things without grumbling and fault-finding and complaining [against God] and questioning and doubting [among yourselves], Philippians 2:14 AMP.*

- * And remember – that often the things that we complain about are small and insignificant compared with what some other people are facing in their lives.

- * **God’s Word also says:**

- * Not judge people by their outward appearance.
- * *God does not see the same way people see. People look at the outside of a person, but the Lord looks at the heart.” 1 Samuel 16:7 NCV*
- * “*Stop judging by outward appearance! Instead, judge correctly*”. *God’s Word John 7:24 NCV*
- * *John 7:24 Stop judging by the way things look, but judge by what is really right.” NCV*
- * Which means – “*don’t judge people by their outward appearance- listen and wait until you have discovered more about them.*”

And also –

It is foolish to answer a matter before you have heard it.

Proverbs 18:13 He who answers a matter before he hears the facts — it is folly and shame to him. AMP

John 7:51 Nicodemus asks, "Doth our law judge any man, before it hear him, and know what he doeth?". KJV

Don't judge a book by its cover – **read the book and find out what's in it.**

My focus & application.

So, I thought I would write a few thoughts along those lines that as believers we would be concerned in learning (listening) to other people's life stories before we made any comment about the person because their outward appearance does not indicate their journey in life.

- * Knowing this better positions us to be able to really serve people.
- * This relates to the people we meet either randomly or interact with from time to time, or those who we see regularly have some discourse with on a regular basis – e.g. a community group or our church.

A Personal challenge

- * In watching a recent TV program called "THE PIANO" where different people from all walks of life come to a public place like a Railway station or Mall and play the piano. But before playing they are interviewed and reveal the challenging stories of their lives – their disabilities, griefs and tragic circumstances of their lives and how playing the piano has helped them overcome to live meaningful lives.
- * But their clothes, demeanor and outward appearance did not reflect what they have been through in life.
- * I was deeply moved and challenged with how insensitive I had been in not trying to at least to know, hear, or be aware of the stories of the people that I interact meet from time to time but particularly those that are close and I see on a regularly basis e.g. at church.

God's message – his reminder.

- * His message to me was not to take people's lives for granted, not to be judge or attempt to evaluate a person's life by their outward appearance.
- * But to hear or know their story – their journey life – and to show empathy towards them.
- * Not to be intimidated in seeking to approach those persons because of their outward appearance which may be different to what I am used to.
- * And this was to apply to those whom I randomly or occasionally meet including those whom I interact with socially, community etc.
- * But it also applies to those that we know and have fellowship with at church and church activities.

Note.

- * It is easy to think that because a person is regularly attending church and they seem to be doing ok in their Christian walk but that might not be the complete picture because there are many who are still struggling with past tragedies, abuse, unforgiveness, bitterness, anger, loneliness, low self-esteem etc and are in need of help to guide them through those things.
- * However, we still need to somehow express that desire to help people who are struggling in their walk with God, and yes, in doing that we will be faced with feelings of not wanting to intrude into people's privacy, or not wanting to get involved or too busy or thinking that we are inadequate to minister at the level we think it will be required.

I am challenged

- * **Showing God** - it is important that we show God that we genuinely care and are interested in people's lives and that we are prepared to be more active in seeking to find ways to be able to know them better, so that we can help them.
- * **Showing God** that through we have a renewed passion to pray for people. yes, we can pray for God's work, but people are so important to God.
- * **Showing God** by taking the next step of being specific (not just general) in naming the person or persons in prayer (privately not publicly) and presenting them to the heavenly father – asking him for an opening or opportunity to be an instrument to bring life, hope and freedom to them.

Amen – Ps Barry